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Discuss the importance of timing as it relates to the introduction of new software in a work environment. Describe an experience you have had with software implementation at your work.

In recent years the software industry and the technology industries in general have undergone rapid growth and especially the Internet. These technologies have reshaped how businesses operate and so does schools. Application software and other related technologies provide tools to solve business problem and educational tools for teaching and learning. As we have seemed over recent years, the Internet and its related technologies—hardware, software, cell-phone (ex. iPhone), PDA—have revolutionaries the industry and communication that businesses and educational institutions are also greatly affected.

Even through this case examines the relationship between training how to use new software and how to teach people to use software. Training and using new software are just two of the many aspects of supporting software or installing software. There are also the costs of maintaining, supporting, operating, and training, which put a lot of strains on schools, teachers, and staff. The funding is another important ongoing factor that needs to consider very carefully.

Selecting the right software is also a challenge for any business and it is not just a challenge for school alone. Many questions are needed to address before implementing and deploying it to the users. Is the software package easy to use? How is the software package being supported? This case is more or less just about how to train the users on new software. However, it also presents many un-answer questions for school, teachers, and staffs, not only about the training aspects, but it's also about the right kind of software for their organization.

From the technology standpoint, I think that early adopters of new software is good, because software vendors are more eager to help you get it up and running by providing free services, support programs, and other incentives. This is just another sales pitch. The real issue is how to get people train and ongoing support for the lifecycle of new software. For educational institutions, I am not sure that this is a good idea, because the costs associated with this kind software/upgrade are huge. Is the potential reward worth the risk?

The timing for installing new software is never a good time. There always will be the cost of downtime and lost productivity. For most parts this case are talking about steps/processes needed to train teachers and staff, but we have seen that the information technology (IT) personnel also needs to get involve in installing new software. I particularly like the idea of collaborative training that teach a group of people to train other teachers/staff. This is a popular training method in the technology industry and I

have personal involved in this kind of training method at work. As this story has unfolded, training is always required for new software.

One of things I can't understand why anyone would choose the old DOS-based application software. School Manager and QuickGrader seem to be good software for schools, but someone just happens to select DOS-based and not Windows-based. Have anyone in our class use DOS or UNIX before?

Here are some issues worth discussing.

"...how upset everyone had been when the information technology (IT) staff ... announcing ... new programs had been installed..." (pg. 51)

"... the timing of the installation, training had been difficult to accomplish." (pg 51).

"...coach other, you need to learn as much as possible about the new software"

"The administration expected all the teachers to begin using both software programs on the first day of school. Only one day in-service scheduled for training."

<http://portal.acm.org/citation.cfm?id=45175.45178>

http://findarticles.com/p/articles/mi_m0SMG/is_n11_v15/ai_17485076